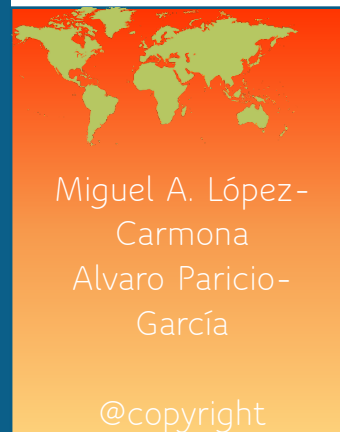
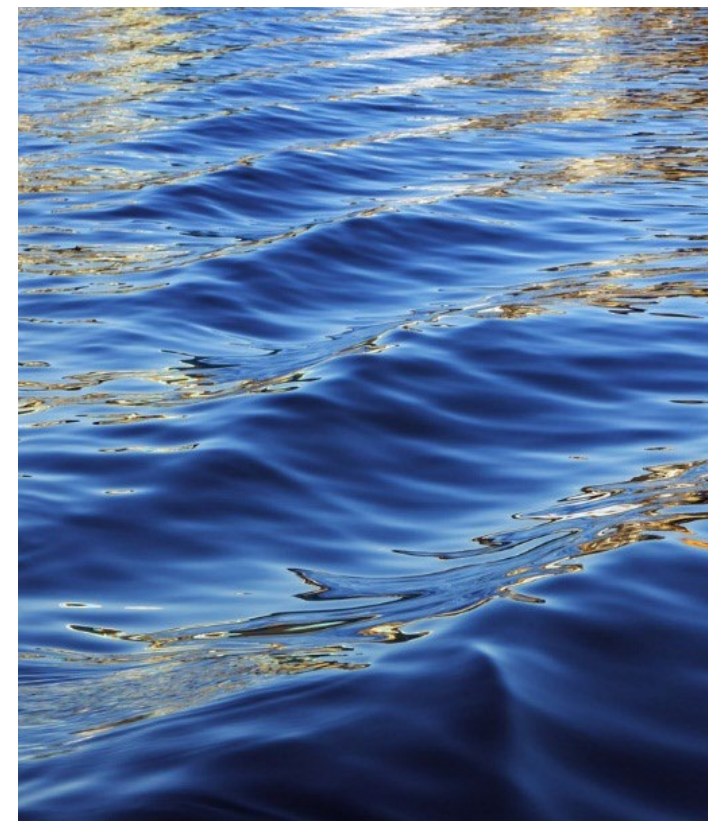




Multimodal Transport



European University Alliance for Global Health



Co-funded by the
European Union



Universidad
de Alcalá



Learning objectives

- Understand the difference between intermodal and multimodal.
- Key stakeholders.
- Transport conventions.
- FIATA Multimodal Bill of Lading (FBL)



Intermodal / Multimodal

- XXX-Modal:
 - Movement of goods using two or more transport modes.
 - In most cases, international handling is implied.
 - Examples: sea + road, rail + air, etc.
- Multimodal: Single contract, one operator responsible.
 - Single point of responsibility: Multimodal Transport Operator (MTO).
 - Multimodal offers streamlined documentation and liability.
- Intermodal: Multiple contracts, each carrier responsible for its leg.
 - Lack of end-to-end responsibility.



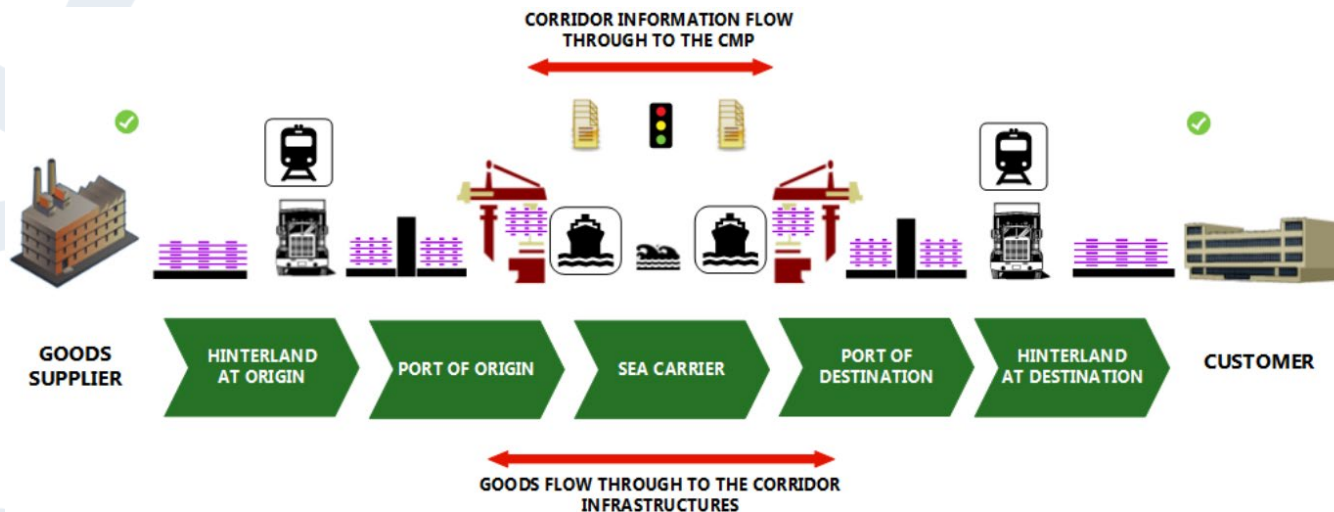
Multi-modal transport

Mode of transport	Typical usage	Advantages	Disadvantages
Road 	Door-to-door Ideal for mixed cargo. Typically used for first and final leg	Most flexible for door-to-door, cheap	Limited to continental transport Urban congestion Damage to roads
Rail 	For domestic, continental and inter-continental transport	Ideal for heavy goods and long distances Environmental-friendly	Connection to rail system required. Complete trains require large volumes (thus low frequency), otherwise handling in yards (low transport speed)
Air 	To ensure fast transport	Fast and safe	Expensive Limits for size and weight Typically as part of multi-modal transport
Sea 	bulk shipments, where long lead time is ok	Ideal for bulky and heavy goods Highly standardized sea containers worldwide Less costly than air for inter-continental transports	inflexible routes Long lead time Inflexible timetables (ship will not wait for missing container)



Multimodal elements

- Stakeholders:
 - MTOs – manage end-to-end journey.
 - Freight forwarders – coordinate shipments.
 - Carriers – execute transport for each mode.
 - Customs brokers, 3PLs/4PLs – support compliance and integration.
- Infrastructure:
 - Ports, terminals, dry ports, logistics hubs.



Montori. 2014. WiderMoS, a new way to make better business by using the EU Core Network Corridors and Smart Logistic



Benefits and Challenges

Benefits

- Cost optimization and modal synergy.
- Environmental sustainability.
- Improved global market access.
- Simplified customer communication (single contact).
- Tolls management.

Challenges

- Complex coordination across modes.
- Risks during transshipment (delays, damages).
- Legal and regulatory inconsistencies.
- Infrastructure limitations in developing regions.



Legal and Compliance

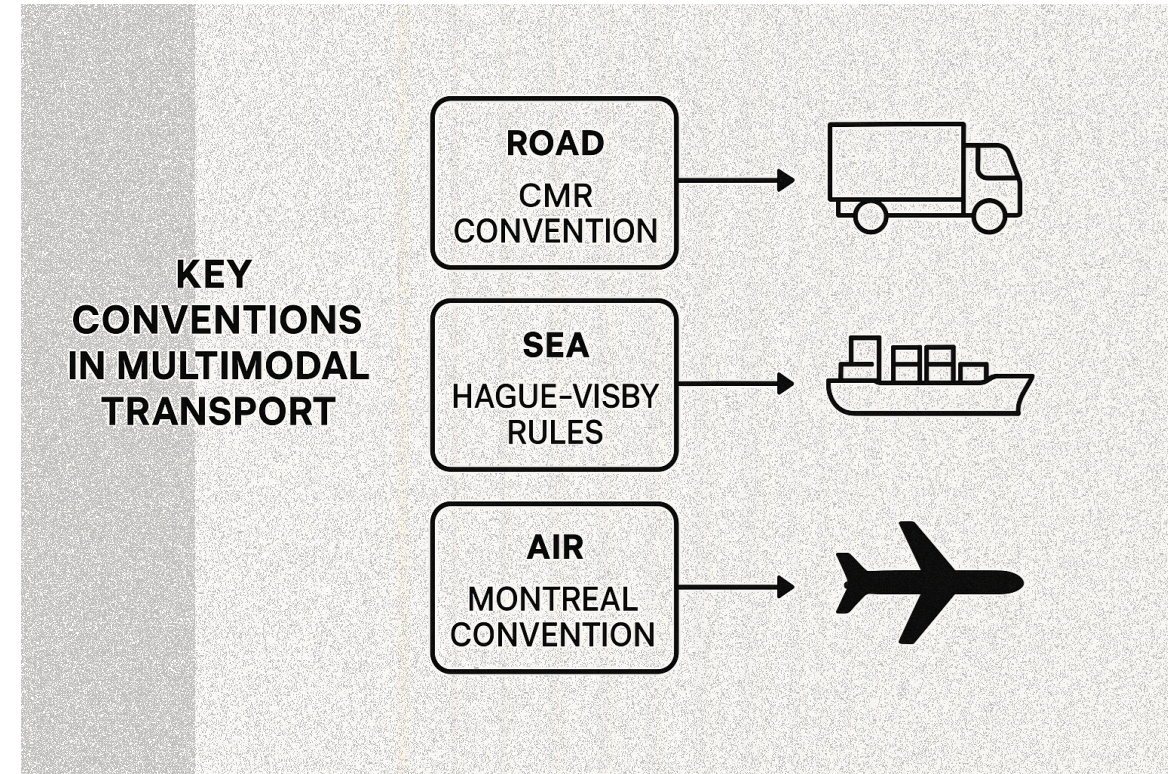
- FIATA Multimodal Bill of Lading (FBL) – global standard document
 - Shipper, consignee, place of receipt, ocean-going vessel, ports of loading and unloading, place of delivery, markings, number and description of packages, gross weight, declaration of interest in timely delivery, declared value, conditions of carriage, freight amount, place and date of shipment, original FBL number and delivery of the goods.
- Liability often mode-specific unless otherwise stated.
- Insurance coverage is critical.

Consignor/Remitente		FBL NEGOTIABLE FIATA MULTIMODAL TRANSPORTE BILL OF LADING		ES	
FETEIA		ORIGINAL			
Issued subject to UNCTAD/ICC Rules for Multimodal Transport Document (ICC Publication 481) CONOCIMIENTO FIATA NEGOCIABLE PARA EL TRANSPORTE MULTIMODAL expedido bajo las normas UNCTAD/CCI para el documento de transporte multimodal (Publicación CCI 481)					
Consigned to order of/ Consignado a la orden de					
Notify address/Dirección					
Place of receipt/Lugar de recepción					
Ocean Vessel/Barco oceánico	Port of Loading/Puerto de embarque				
Port of Discharge/Puerto de descarga	Place of delivery/Lugar de entrega				
Marks and Numbers Marcas y números	Number and kind of packages Número y clase de bultos	Description of goods Descripción de la mercancía	Gross Weight Peso bruto	Measure Medidas	
Declaration of interest of the consignor in timely delivery (Clause 6.2) Declaración de interés del remitente sobre el plazo de entrega (Cláusula 6.2)		Declared value for ad valorem rate according to the declaration of the consignor (Clauses 7 and 8) Valor declarado para la tasa según declaración del remitente (Cláusulas 7 y 8)			
The goods and instructions are accepted and dealt with subject to the Standard Conditions printed overleaf Las mercancías e instrucciones se acogen y están sujetas a las condiciones generales impresas al dorso					
Freight Amount/Importe del flete		Freight payable at /Flete pagado en		Place and date of issue/Lugar y fecha de expedición	
Cargo Insurance through the undersigned/Seguro por cuenta de los que suscriben ☐ No Cubierto ☐ Cubierto según póliza		Number of Original FBL's Número de FBL originales		Stamp and Signature/Sello y firma	
For delivery of goods please apply to:/Para la entrega de la mercancía rogamos dirigirse a:				As Carrier	

Key Multimodal Transport Conventions

When damage occurs, the mode where it happened determines the applicable convention

- If the mode is unknown, default rules or national laws may apply
- Multimodal Transport Operators (MTOs) help manage liability and documentation
- Legal complexity highlights the importance of contracts and cargo insurance





CMR Convention (Road Transport)

- Convention on the Contract for the International Carriage of Goods by Road (1956)
- Governs international road transport in Europe and parts of Asia
- Establishes carrier's liability for loss, damage, or delay
- Applies even within a multimodal shipment if road is included
- Limits compensation per kilogram unless misconduct is proven



Hague-Visby Rules (Sea Transport)

- Amendment to the original Hague Rules (1924), modified in 1968
- Governs the carriage of goods by sea under a bill of lading
- Defines carrier responsibilities (seaworthiness, proper handling)
- Liability is limited per package or weight unit
- Applies only during the sea leg of a multimodal journey



Montreal Convention (Air Transport)

- Convention for the Unification of Certain Rules for International Carriage by Air (1999)
- Applies to international carriage of cargo by air
- Covers damage, loss, or delay with strict liability up to a limit
- Higher compensation possible with proof of negligence
- Applies to air segments in multimodal transport